

**MUST FOR EVERY STUDENT ... FOR ALL COMPETITIVE EXAMS**

# **ENGLISH MADE SIMPLE!**

**LEARN WITH GVR SIR**

**MODULE - 20**





**Abreast** : *Two or more people, next to each other and moving in the same direction/facing the same direction.*

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**Example :**  
Geeta and Radha were running  
two **abreast** around the track.



**Abreast** : *If one keeps abreast of a subject, he stays informed about new developments in it.*

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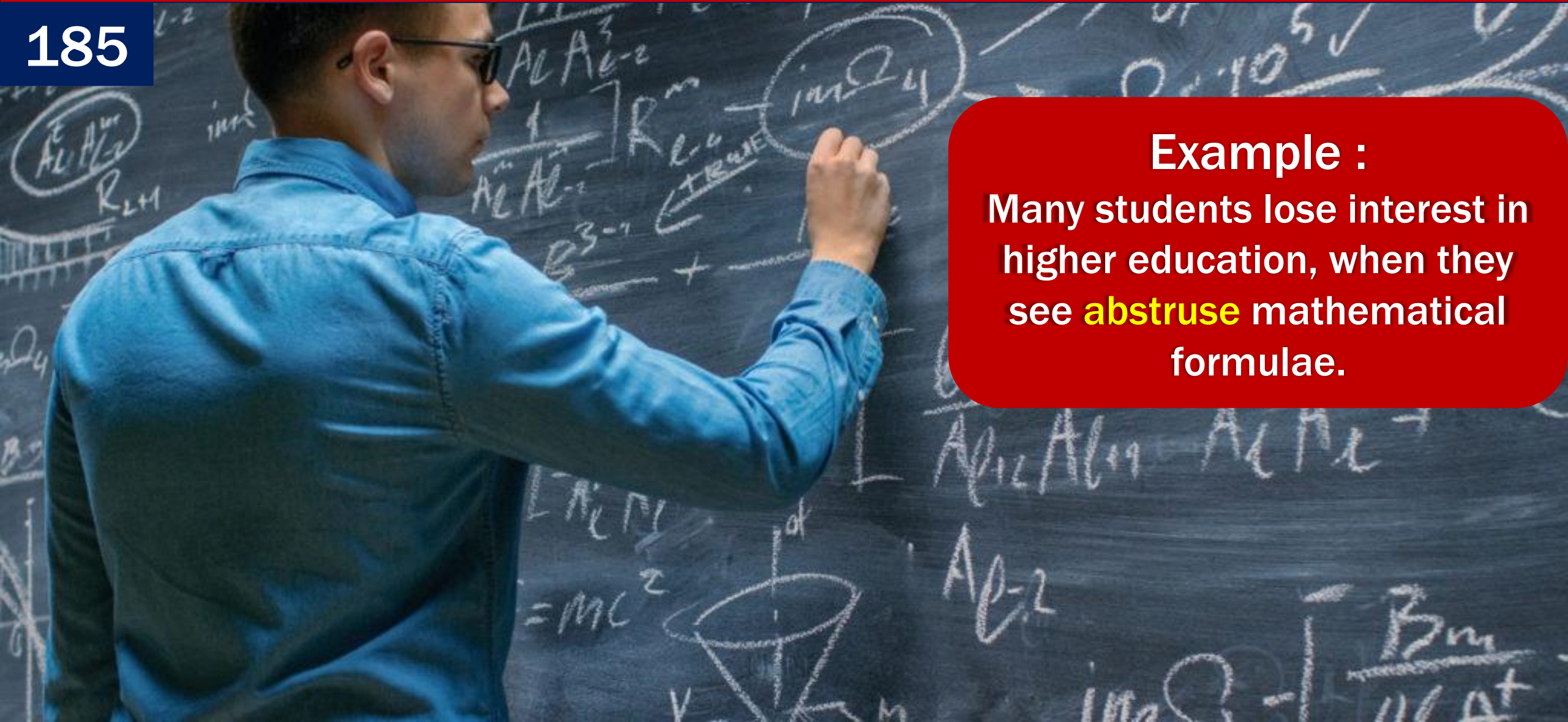


**Example :**  
To move up the ladder in the software sector, one must stay **abreast** of new software releases.



**Abstruse** : *Difficult to understand/not understood by many people.*

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**Example :**  
Many students lose interest in higher education, when they see **abstruse** mathematical formulae.

**Consolation** : *Something that makes someone who is sad or disappointed, feel better.*

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**Example :**  
XXX lost her husband and one  
can only offer a few words of  
**consolation.**



**Consolation** : *Something that makes someone who is sad or disappointed, feel better.*

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**Example :**

In the recent Ed Tech Sector layoffs, Raju lost his job. The **consolation** is that he got another job at half the salary.

**Overbroad** : *Too widely applicable/applied, excessively broad, not specific enough.*

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**Example :**  
The legislations affecting  
fundamental rights of citizens  
should not be **overbroad**.



**Omission :** *The fact of not including something that should have been included or vice versa.*

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**Example :**

The glaring **omission** of the proposed legislation for the appointment of Chief Election Commissioner/Election Commissioners is the executive majority, due to which the independence/autonomy of the Election Commission may be compromised.



***Deemed*** : To consider or judge something in a particular way

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**Example :**

**With the Forest (Conservation) Amendment Act 2023, the concept of **deemed** forest has gone away.**



**Deemed** : *To consider or judge something in a particular way*

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**Example :**

With the increase in the violence caused by drug cartels, Ecuador has now been **deemed** unsafe.



**Subserve** : *Help to further or promote.*

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**Example :**

Nowadays, several media houses are aligned with specific political ideologies, and they use debates/writings to **subserve** these political interests.

**549**

Tweets as of 09:08 PM

**#FringeVsPadmavati**

ENGAGE WITH A R NAB ON THE DEBATE



***Subserve*** : To be useful/instrumental in promoting a purpose, action, etc.

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**Example :**  
When we do light exercise, it **subserves** digestion.



***Watchdog*** : A person or organization responsible for making certain that companies obey particular standards and do not act illegally.

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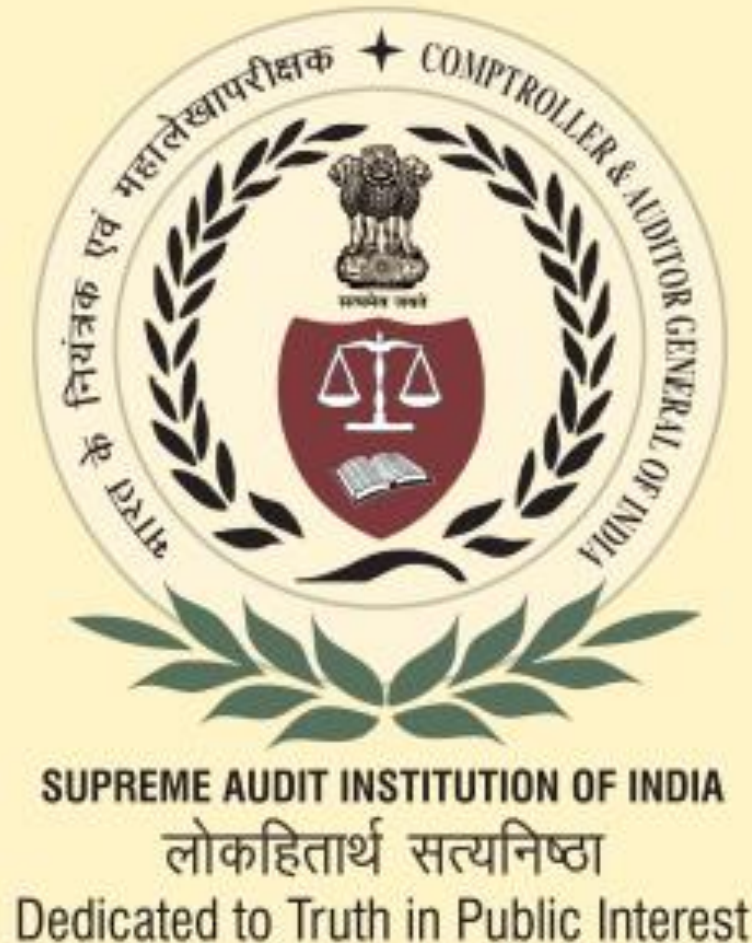
**Example :**  
Competition Commission of India  
is the competition **watchdog**.





***Watchdog*** : A person or organization responsible for making certain that companies obey particular standards and do not act illegally.

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**Example :**  
The expenditure **watchdog** is  
Comptroller and Auditor  
General of India.

***Pre-empt*** : To do or say something before someone, so that you make their words or actions unnecessary or not effective.

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**Example :**  
After the Bahanaga Bazar train accident, the Railway Minister held a press conference in order to **pre-empt** criticism in the Media.



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Companies should **pre-empt** negative criticism  
with transparent  
information dissemination



29-09-2023

## EVERGREEN REVOLUTION

Most fitting tribute to MS Swaminathan would be to restore centrality of science — and scientists — in agriculture

**M**SSWAMINATHAN MAY not have developed the high-yielding wheat varieties that ushered in India's Green Revolution during the mid- and late-Sixties. The varieties that farmers sowed were originally bred in Mexico by the legendary Norman Borlaug. Even the subsequent blockbuster varieties such as Kalyan Sona and Sonalika that produced amber-coloured grain with better chapati-making quality than the red Mexican wheats were bred by men — the likes of VS Mathur, SP Kohli and DS Athwal — not as well known in the popular imagination. Swaminathan's key role was in recognising the potential of the new genetic strains or "plant type" responsive to increased fertiliser and water application, and devising a coherent strategy for their introduction and large-scale planting by farmers. He was a rare combination of someone who was abreast with the latest developments in agricultural sciences — including the deployment of the dwarf Norin-10 wheat genes by American researchers — and someone who could also work through the bureaucratic and political establishment for translating his strategic vision into farmers' fields.

Indian agriculture today lacks a champion pursuing strategic objectives for the sector with missionary zeal like Swaminathan. It equally lacks committed ministers and civil servants like C Subramaniam and B Sivaramakrishnan, who valued scientific opinion and could take bold decisions — such as importing 18,000 tonnes of seeds of Borlaug's Mexican wheats in 1966. Contrast that informed resoluteness with the current procrastination over genetic modification and new breeding technologies — a dawdling based not on science as much as unsubstantiated fears of the unknown. The most fitting tribute to Swaminathan would be to restore the centrality of science — and scientists — in agriculture and, like him, to trust the wisdom and ability of the Indian farmer to adopt and adapt to new technologies.

The Borlaug-Swaminathan Green Revolution strategy basically relied on breeding varieties that would produce more grain with more fertiliser, especially nitrogen, and water application. That simple "more input, more output" strategy has probably run its course. Today, the challenge is breeding for climate change (short winters, temperature spikes, fewer rainy days and extreme precipitation were relatively unknown phenomena during Swaminathan's time) and improving water and nutrient use efficiency. In other words, "less input, more output". Swaminathan was right about the Green Revolution; it turned India from a "ship to mouth" importer to a country that became self-sufficient in food grains. He was equally right about aiming for an "Evergreen Revolution", which, in his words, was an "improvement of productivity in perpetuity without ecological harm".

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